Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

CTE Towy Cottage

Carmarthen

01994419420

https://rmt.org/

The inspection visit took place on 30/06/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Transform Residential Limited
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults and Children Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability, Provision for mental health
Registered places:	3
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Excellent
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

People living at Towy cottage experience excellent well-being outcomes. People are supported to achieve their aspirations through meaningful education, community involvement, positive relationships and a wide range of activities. Their communication needs are met effectively, family relationships are promoted and maintained, and safeguarding arrangements help people feel safe and supported. The service is also working towards the Welsh Active Offer, helping people engage with Welsh language and culture.

People achieve good outcomes from the care and support they receive. Thorough assessments, detailed personal plans, health plans and behaviour support plans provide care staff with information to meet people's needs consistently. People receive support to access healthcare services, and daily records evidence the support provided and outcomes achieved. Medication systems are organised and managed safely.

People live in a good quality environment which supports their well-being. The home is comfortable, welcoming and personalised, with bedrooms reflecting people's interests and preferences. Communal areas support social interaction and leisure, whilst outdoor spaces provide opportunities for recreation and gardening activities. The kitchen is clean, well-organised and has achieved a Food Standards Agency food hygiene rating of five.

People benefit from good leadership and management arrangements. The manager and Responsible Individual (RI) provide effective oversight through quality assurance, monitoring and governance processes. A stable staff team promotes continuity and consistency for people. Safe recruitment practices are followed, and care staff receive regular supervision and training. Positive feedback from families and care staff reflects a service with a supportive and person-centred culture.

Findings:

Well-being — Excellent

People experience excellent well-being outcomes because care staff provide highly effective support which promotes independence, choice and achievement. People are treated with dignity and respect and are actively involved in decisions about their daily lives. Care staff know people exceptionally well and use this knowledge to build confidence, encourage personal development and support people to achieve their aspirations.

People are extensively supported to maintain and improve their physical, emotional and mental well-being. Care staff ensure people access routine and specialist health services, annual health checks and professional support when required. People benefit from a wide range of meaningful activities which promote healthy lifestyles, social engagement and positive emotional well-being. These include football, gardening, arts and crafts, community events and recreational activities. Planned holidays and trips away provide enriching experiences, broaden social opportunities and enhance confidence and independence.

People benefit from excellent educational opportunities through attendance at the provider's specialist college. Educational programmes are tailored to people's interests, strengths and aspirations and include activities such as pottery, weaving, woodworking, creative arts and horticultural and growing activities. Care staff work closely with college staff to ensure a consistent approach between education and residential support, helping people achieve positive outcomes and develop practical skills which enhance everyday life. This highly effective approach helps people build confidence, fulfil their potential and experience a strong sense of achievement.

People are exceptionally well supported to maintain relationships with family members and others who are important to them. Communication between the service and families is extensive and highly valued. Families consistently praised the quality of support provided. One family member told us the service is doing an *"Amazing job",* whilst another described the progress made by their relative as *"Incredible".* Families also described communication from care staff and managers as *"Excellent"* and *"Brilliant".* These strong partnerships enhance people's emotional well-being and provide reassurance and continuity.

People make a valuable contribution to their communities and are supported to engage meaningfully in society. They participate in local clubs, community groups, Mencap activities and social events which promote inclusion, friendships and a sense of belonging. People also contribute to life within the service through regular meetings, activity planning and involvement in environmental projects.

People’s communication needs are met to a very high standard. Care staff use easy-read information, visual aids, widgets and social stories to support understanding and participation. Regular meetings and key worker sessions provide opportunities for people to express their views and influence decisions.

People are safeguarded through strong and effective arrangements. The service is also working towards the Welsh Active Offer through bilingual resources, Welsh words of the week and cultural activities, resulting in meaningful opportunities for people to engage with Welsh language and culture.

Care & Support — Good

People receive good quality care and support because systems and processes are organised and provide care staff with relevant information to meet people's needs consistently. Assessments completed before people move into the service are thorough and consider care and support needs, known risks, compatibility with others and desired outcomes. These are reviewed regularly and provide a clear rationale for how the service can meet people's needs.

Personal plans are detailed, strengths-based and person-centred. They provide care staff with clear information about people's daily routines, preferences, health needs and support requirements. Plans are written from the person's perspective and contain practical guidance which promotes consistency of care. We found plans include information about likes and dislikes, personal care needs, health requirements and routines important to people. Systems are in place to ensure care staff read and understand plans and any updates made.

Health plans contain information about people's health needs, prescribed medication, healthcare professionals involved in their care and arrangements for accessing health appointments. This information helps care staff understand the support people require and promotes a consistent approach to meeting health needs. Records demonstrated people regularly access healthcare services and receive support to attend routine and specialist appointments. Information relating to health conditions and ongoing treatment is recorded clearly, helping care staff provide consistent support.

Behaviour support plans provide useful guidance about people's individual needs, triggers and preferred approaches. Care staff have access to clear information about how best to support people during periods of anxiety or distress. Plans promote positive behaviour support and focus on reducing the likelihood of incidents occurring. Risk assessments complement these plans and identify potential risks alongside measures required to keep people safe while supporting their independence.

Daily records provide a good overview of people's experiences and the support provided. Entries evidence participation in activities, attendance at appointments, progress towards goals and any significant events which occur. Records are detailed and help demonstrate how people spend their time and the outcomes they achieve. Incident reporting systems are good and records identify actions taken to keep people safe.

Medication systems are safe and well organised. Medication is stored appropriately and records are completed consistently. Clear protocols are in place where required, including arrangements for prescribed and non-prescribed medication. Regular audits, stock checks and monitoring processes help ensure medication is managed safely and people receive medicines as intended. Overall, people benefit from care and support which is well planned, consistent and responsive to their

individual needs.

Environment — Good

People live in an environment which is comfortable, welcoming and suitable for their needs. The home provides a domestic setting where people can personalise their bedrooms with items reflecting their interests, hobbies and personalities. Bedrooms contain personal belongings, photographs and memorabilia, helping create familiar surroundings and promoting a sense of ownership and individuality.

Communal areas are well furnished and support both social interaction and relaxation. People have access to spaces where they can spend time together, participate in activities or relax independently. The living room provides a comfortable area for leisure and socialising, while displays throughout the home celebrate people's experiences, achievements and interests. Accessible information and activity planners help people remain informed and involved in daily life.

The kitchen is clean, well-organised and stocked with a variety of food options to meet people's needs and preferences. The service has achieved a Food Standards Agency food hygiene rating of five, demonstrating high standards of food safety and hygiene. Adjacent to the kitchen, the dining area provides a welcoming space for meals and social interaction and contains accessible information, activity planners and resources which support people's involvement in daily life and menu choices.

People benefit from an environment which encourages participation and independence. Information boards and easy-read resources help people understand what is happening within the service and contribute to decisions affecting daily life. Photographs displayed throughout the home reflect activities, holidays and achievements, creating a positive and person-centred atmosphere.

Outdoor areas contribute positively to people's well-being. The garden provides opportunities for recreation, relaxation and meaningful occupation. People are involved in gardening activities and growing herbs, vegetables and other plants. This supports engagement in purposeful activities and provides opportunities to enjoy outdoor space. Seating areas and recreational facilities further enhance opportunities for social interaction and leisure.

The provider has arrangements in place to maintain the environment and promote people's safety. Regular health and safety checks, environmental audits and maintenance processes help ensure the premises remain suitable for the people living there. Records evidenced routine monitoring of fire safety systems, water temperatures and other key health and safety measures. Maintenance issues are monitored through established systems, supporting the ongoing upkeep of the home.

People benefit from clear emergency arrangements. Personal Emergency Evacuation Plans

provide guidance for care staff on supporting people in the event of an emergency, and fire drills take place regularly to familiarise people and care staff with procedures.

Overall, people live in a homely and well-maintained environment which supports comfort, safety and well-being. The facilities available promote meaningful occupation, social interaction and positive daily experiences for people living at the service.

Leadership & Management — Good

People benefit from a service which is well managed and provides effective oversight of care and support. The manager and RI have established governance arrangements which support the safe and smooth operation of the service. The manager maintains a visible presence within the home and has developed positive relationships with people, families and care staff. Feedback gathered during the inspection demonstrated confidence in the management of the service and the quality of support people receive.

Quality assurance systems help the manager and RI monitor service delivery and identify opportunities for improvement. Regular audits, health and safety checks, team meetings and reviews of care and support contribute to ongoing monitoring of the service. Quality of Care Reviews demonstrate consultation with people, families and care staff and identify actions to support service development. These reviews highlight positive outcomes for people, including increased independence, community engagement and access to healthcare services. The RI undertakes regular visits to the service and maintains oversight of care, safeguarding, staffing and environmental matters.

People benefit from a stable and consistent staff team. Staffing arrangements provide continuity of support and help people develop trusting relationships with care staff. The service does not rely on agency care staff and has maintained a consistent workforce. Rotas are organised effectively and ensure people receive support from care staff who know them well and understand their needs.

Safe recruitment practices help ensure people are supported by suitable care staff. Staff files contained the required recruitment information, including proof of identity, references, employment history and Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) checks. Records demonstrated care staff are registered with Social Care Wales or are progressing towards registration requirements. These arrangements help promote people's safety and well-being.

Care staff receive regular supervision and have access to training relevant to their roles. Training records demonstrated nearly all care staff have completed mandatory training, including safeguarding, first aid and mental capacity training. Supervision sessions are completed regularly and include discussions about well-being, safeguarding, service developments, performance and learning needs. This supports care staff to remain knowledgeable and confident in their roles.

Care staff spoke positively about working at the service and the support provided by the manager. One care staff member told us, *“It’s a good team to work for”* and said they felt supported within their role. Another care staff member stated, *“The manager is excellent, she is very supportive.”* Additional feedback described the home as *“A safe, homely environment”* and highlighted

opportunities to *“make a real difference”* to people's lives. Care staff consistently spoke about seeing people develop skills, gain confidence and achieve positive outcomes.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

CIW has no areas for improvement identified following this inspection.

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

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